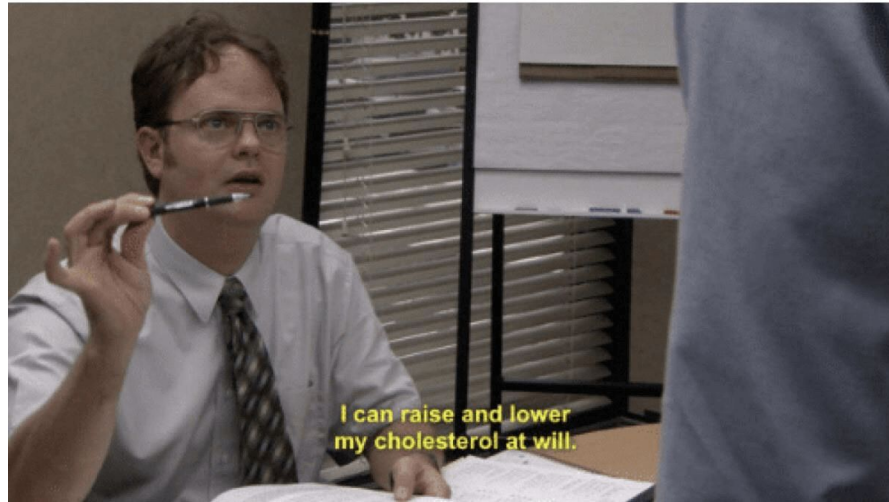


You have 10 seconds to impress

... good luck! 👍

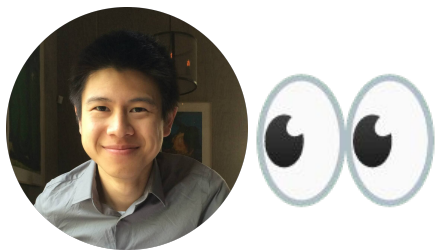
When your resume feels too short so you start adding random “special skills”



I'm Alex

- My goal: **Make your resume get as many interviews as possible** 🎯
- Tech Lead at Course Hero, Meta, and Robinhood (\$750k TC)
- Helped thousands of engineers land their dream jobs
- Extensively involved in hiring for all 4 prior companies (250+ interviews)



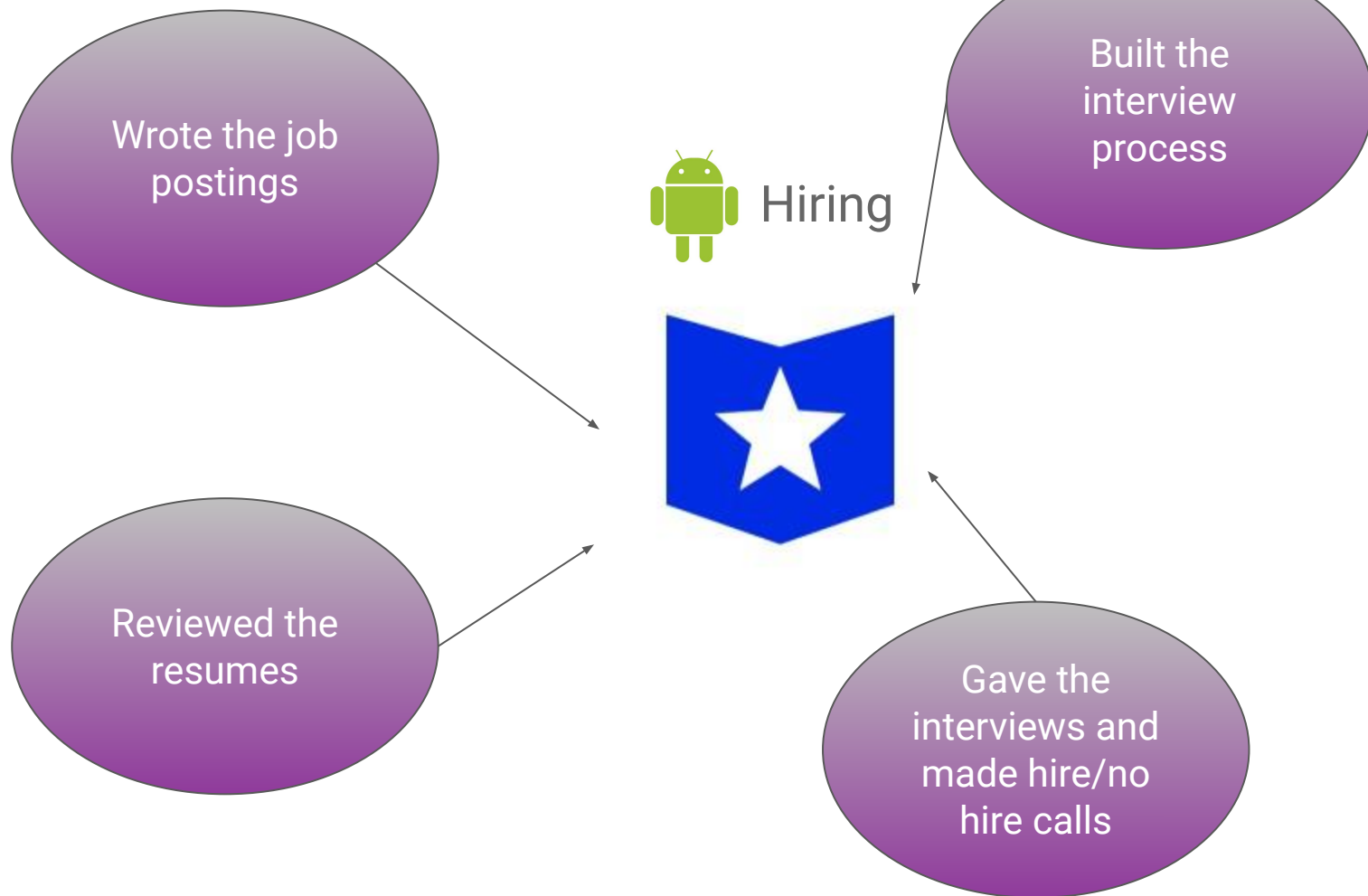


1,000+ resumes

Resume review



1,000+ resumes
rejected



Resumes Are A Solved Problem

- **Good news:** It's not that hard to optimize your resume
- Just need to follow the *proper* advice and put in the work for a great resume
- Problem: There's a ton of misinformation about what makes a resume good
 - Lots of incompetence



Objectives



Truly understand the **principles** behind a stellar resume



Avoid the common **traps** that make resumes suck



Get **maximum credit** by best framing your experience



Make the right resume based on your **level**

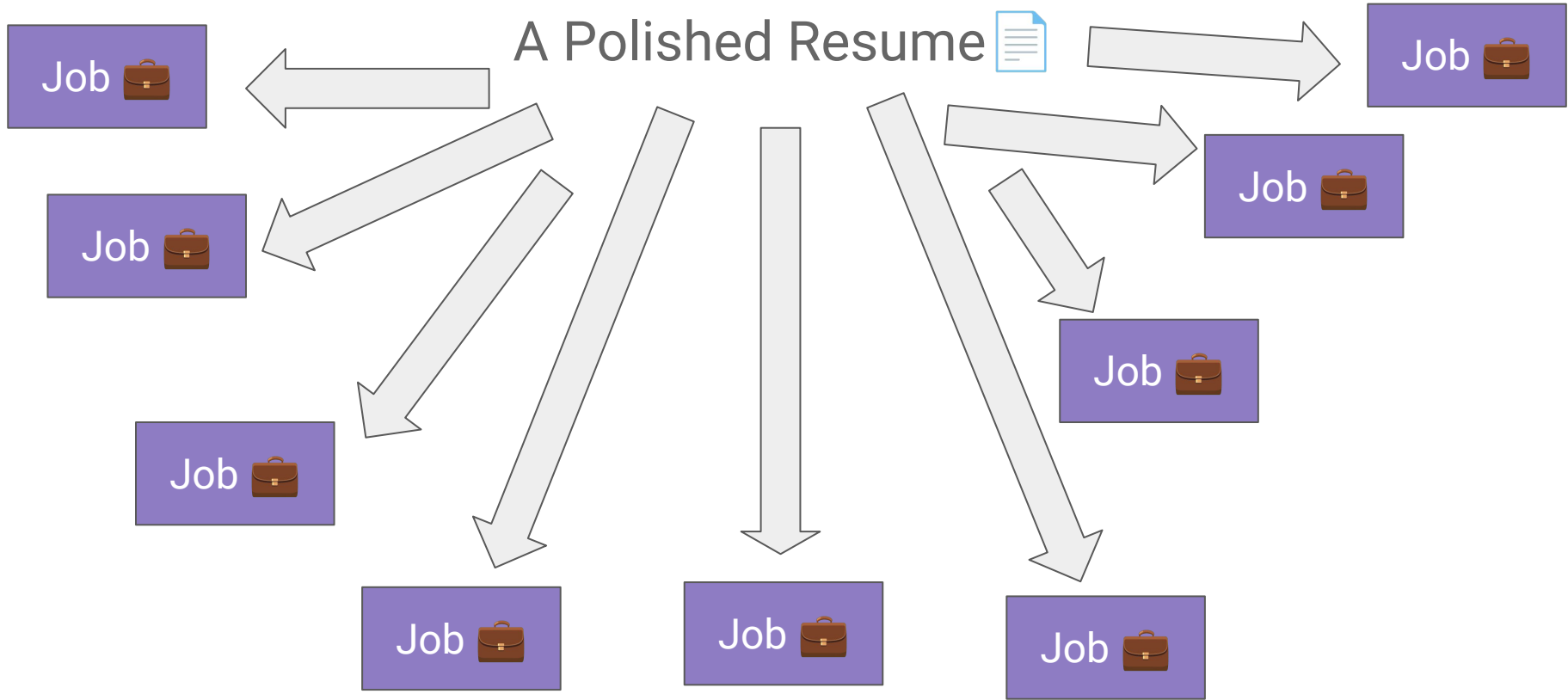


Know what to do if your resume **isn't enough**

Why You NEED A Killer Resume



A Polished Resume



Resume Optimization Is *Incredible* ROI

- The resume check is the first part of the recruiting funnel
 - You aren't getting anywhere if you fail here
- Making your resume better is the definition of multiplicative impact
 - It will be sent to 100s, if not 1000s of jobs



The Key To Writing A Great Resume



Let's Role Play!

We Are An... Engineering Recruiter 🤖

① I am *completely* slammed with candidates to process.

② I am non-technical.



Recruiter

“Hey LinkedIn, I’m hiring for a junior engineer role. Apply here: COOL_URL”

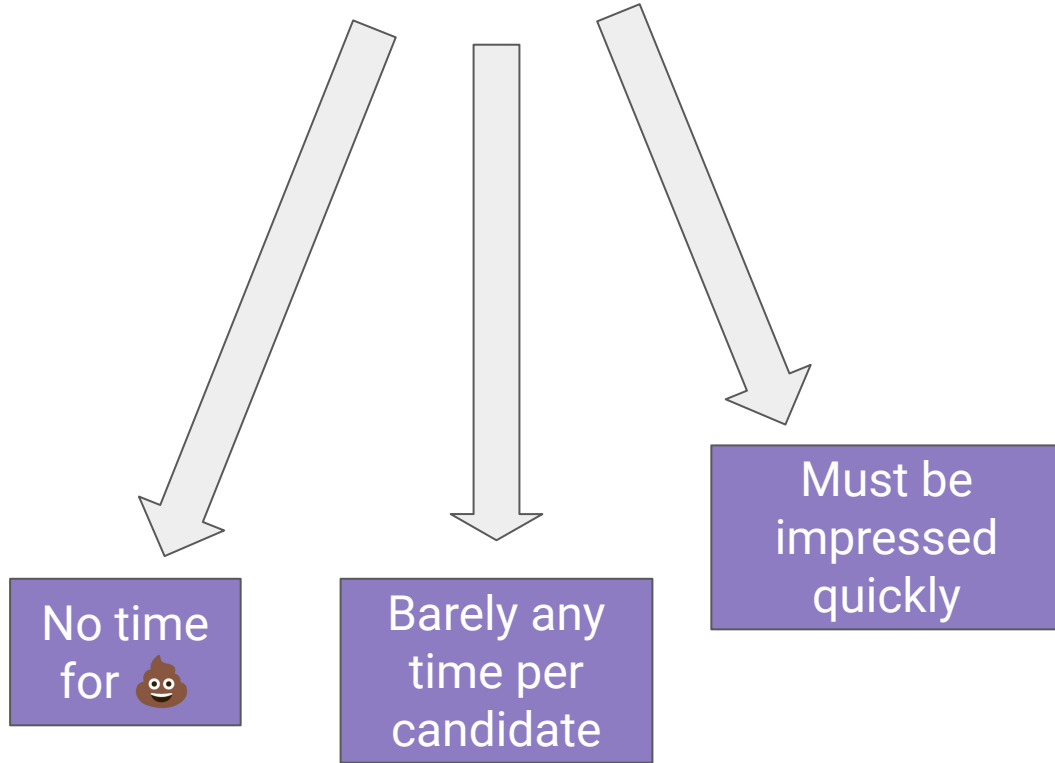


2,500+ Resumes
Within 24 Hours 🤯

7.4 seconds

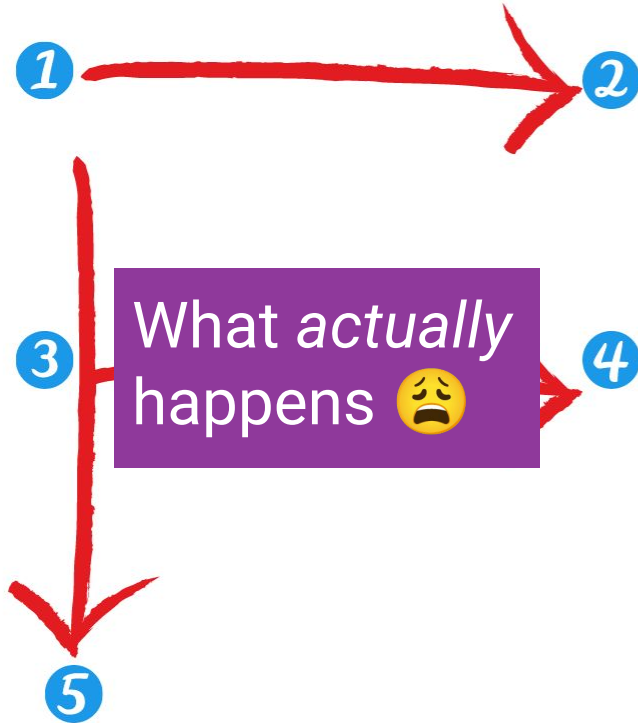
Make it count.

Too Many Candidates

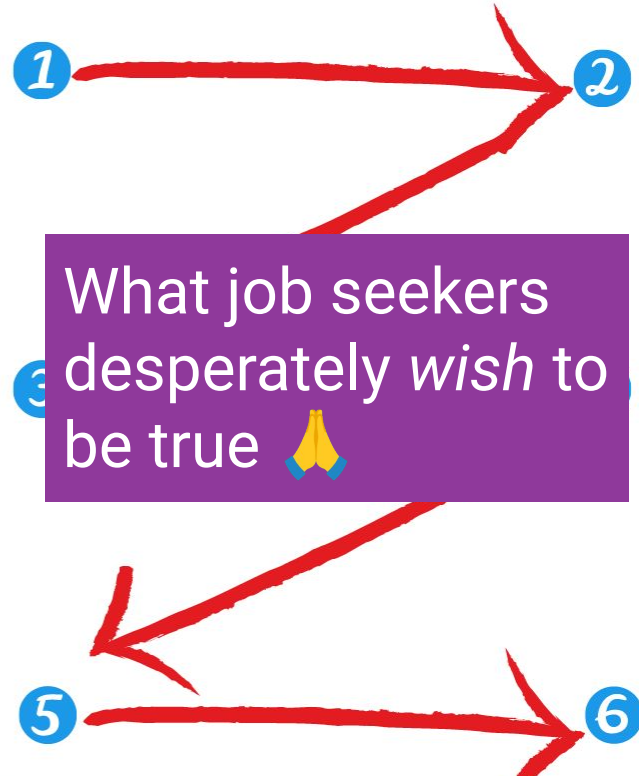


Layout Scanning Patterns

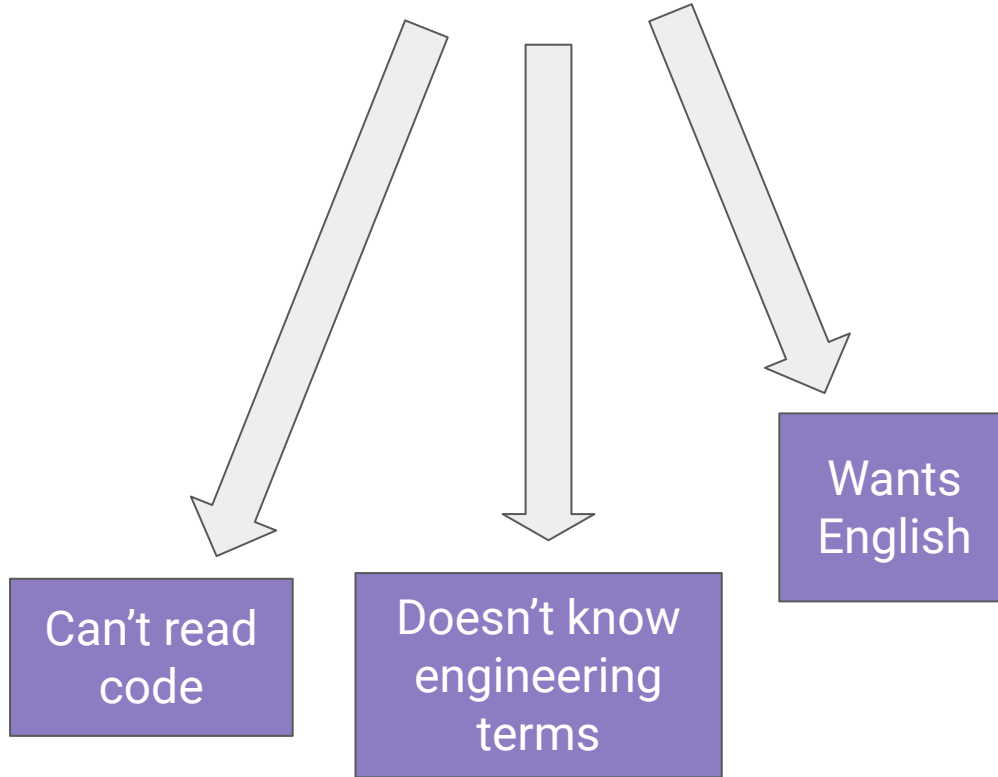
F-MOTION



Z-MOTION



Non-Technical



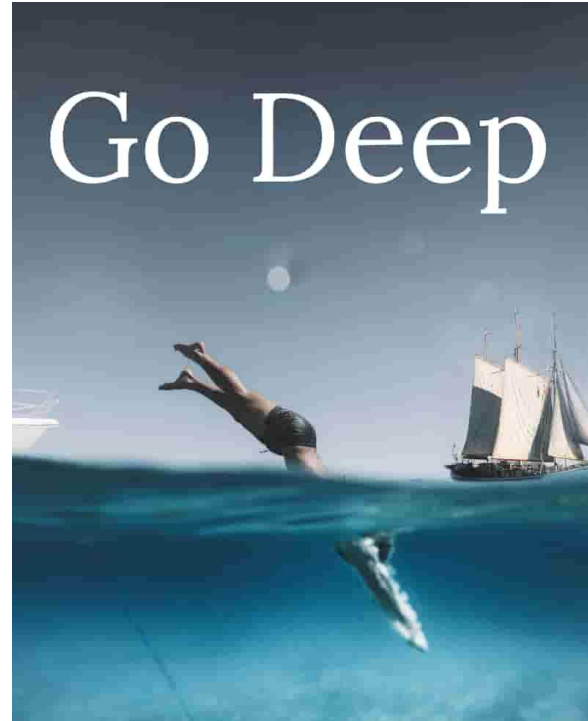
**Put yourself in the shoes of a recruiter
and see the world through their eyes.**

1 Resume To Rule Them All



Pick A Lane

- **Expectation:** *"If I have a resume for every engineer type, I can apply to all the jobs ever! 🧠"*
- **Reality:** You get rejected from everything and your brain explodes preparing for 3+ different tech stacks. 😞
- *Make 1 incredibly good, focused resume*



How To Figure Out Your 1 Resume

- 1 Choose the tech stack you are the most competent in.
- 2 If there's a tie, use passion as a tiebreaker.
- 3 If Step #2 doesn't work, make 2 resumes, apply to ~50 jobs each, and see where you get traction.

Resume Gaps

“Can you explain this gap in your resume?”



Yes. That is when I did not have a job.

There's A Reason Resume Gaps Hurt



garry



@garrynewman

Two weeks without coding and I've forgotten 30 years of experience

12:12 AM · Jan 2, 2023 · **158.8K** Views

Resume Gaps Are Natural

- Be honest, embrace the gaps, and include them
 - It's natural anyways from the time ranges
- No need to call it out, both in resume and interview
- To fill in the gap:
 - Consulting/freelancing
 - Side projects
 - Open source



You were laid off



"I was laid off" (People are generally sympathetic)

You were fired



"It wasn't a good fit between the company and myself"

You left due to health issues



"I needed time to work on myself and become the best version of me"

Traps To Avoid

Poor Spelling And Grammar

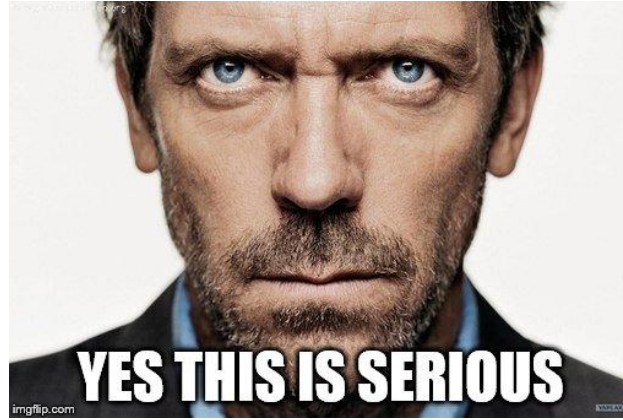
It looked like

their wasnt

anything they could

There's No Room For Error

- **Many recruiters will throw out your resume if it has just 1 basic error**
- These mistakes show poor prioritization and lack of attention to detail
 - You have no excuse
- This can be hard as many engineers don't have English as their 1st language





Junior Engineer

"It's just a small typo - Can't you let me off the hook?"



Hiring Manager

"This is your most important professional document and you had an effectively infinite amount of time to hyper-polish this. Are you serious?"

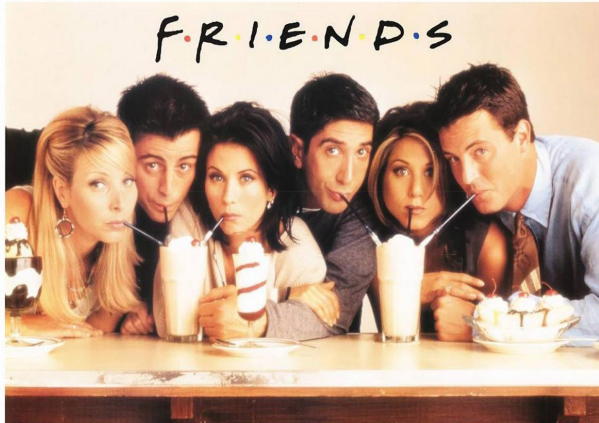
It's Easier Than Ever To Write Good English



ChatGPT



grammarly



*Especially those
who have better
English skills than
you!

It's Too Long

tl;dr

[too long; didn't read]

Shorter Is Better

- *For 95%+ of engineers, their resume should be **exactly 1 page long***
- 10 years of experience (YOE) = 1 page, at most 5 YOE = 1 page
- Recruiters are stretched
 - Overly long resumes = Auto-Reject
- Be concise and prioritize



Resume Page 1:
9/10
impressiveness

Resume Page 2:
7/10
impressiveness

Resume Page 3:
5/10
impressiveness



Recruiter

"These are just less
impressive than the
1st page - Why would
I care about these?"

Ways To Trim It Down

- 1 Remove old experience
- 2 Ruthlessly prioritize, cut weaker accomplishments
- 3 Simple format, minimal sections and nesting
- 4 Say the same with less words (use ChatGPT)

Look Out For Dangling Newlines 🙄

Simple Flashcards Plus (Android Application)

July 2016 – Present

- Full-stack Android application which allows users to create and study flashcard sets, powered by a Node.js REST API using PostgreSQL as the database



Simple Flashcards Plus (Android Application)

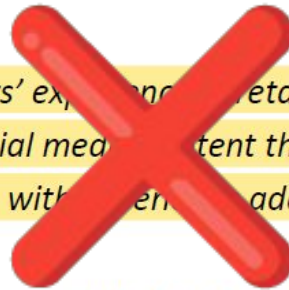
July 2016 – Present

- Full-stack app for creating and studying flashcards, powered by a Node.js REST API with a PostgreSQL database



Intro Summaries





Trend savvy Information Science major with 2 years' experience in retail and consistent record of advancement to leadership positions. Passionate about creating compelling social media content that increases customer engagement and drives website traffic and sales. Data-driven with a knack for adapting to virtual business needs.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Information Science & E-Society | GPA: 3.83

May 2023

Minor In Communication

University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ

Related Coursework: Digital Commerce, Digital Storytelling & Culture, Digital Engagement, Mass Communication, Qualitative Internet Research



I Know (Suck At) Everything



Employers are looking for mastery, not knowledge.

EXPECTATION

"Oh wow, this engineer knows everything! We need to give them an interview immediately!"



Recruiter

REALITY

"Looks like this engineer sucks at everything. Easy reject."

Your Resume
Listing 25+
Technologies

Before

⇒ **Languages:** C, C++, JavaScript, Python, ~~Ocaml~~, Perl, Prolog, Java, HTML, CSS

After

⇒ **Languages:** Java (Android), Kotlin (Android)

I fear not the man
who has practiced
10,000 kicks once,
but I fear the man
who has practiced one
kick 10,000 times.

- Bruce Lee





Only put down technologies you are **very** familiar with



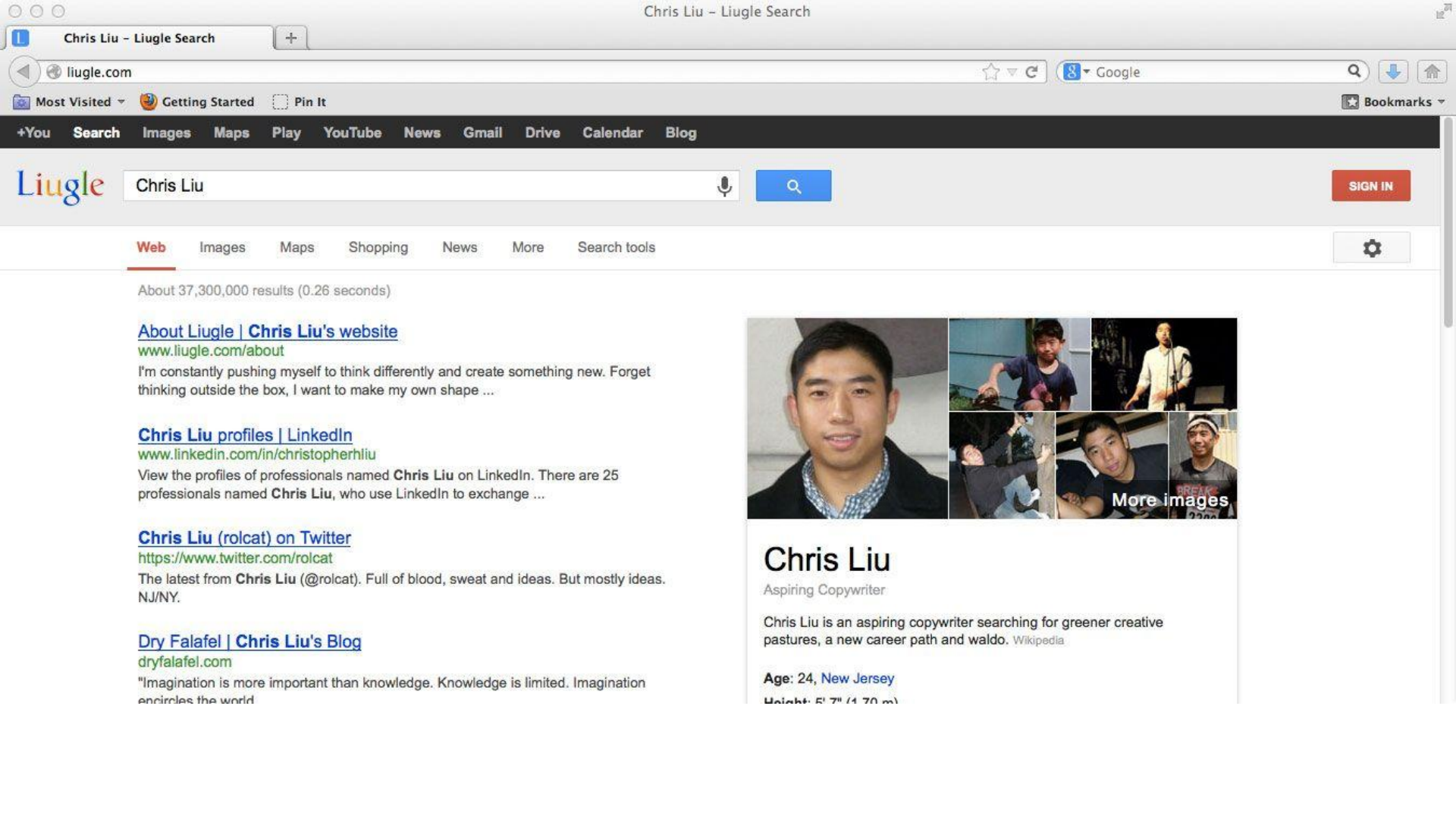
Be prepared to **defend** anything on your resume



Can you have a **great talk** with a senior FAANG engineer about it?

Fancy Formats





About 37,300,000 results (0.26 seconds)

[About Liugle | Chris Liu's website](#)www.liugle.com/about

I'm constantly pushing myself to think differently and create something new. Forget thinking outside the box, I want to make my own shape ...

[Chris Liu profiles | LinkedIn](#)www.linkedin.com/in/christopherhliu

View the profiles of professionals named **Chris Liu** on LinkedIn. There are 25 professionals named **Chris Liu**, who use LinkedIn to exchange ...

[Chris Liu \(rolcat\) on Twitter](#)<https://www.twitter.com/rolcat>

The latest from **Chris Liu** (@rolcat). Full of blood, sweat and ideas. But mostly ideas. NJ/NY.

[Dry Falafel | Chris Liu's Blog](#)dryfalafel.com

"Imagination is more important than knowledge. Knowledge is limited. Imagination encircles the world"



Chris Liu

Aspiring Copywriter

Chris Liu is an aspiring copywriter searching for greener creative pastures, a new career path and waldo. [Wikipedia](#)

Age: 24, [New Jersey](#)

Height: 5' 7" (1.70 m)

EXPECTATION

“Oh wow, this engineer is so creative! We need to give them an interview immediately!”



Recruiter

REALITY

“Ugh, I don’t have time to figure out what’s going on here. I’ll just reject it.”

Your
Ultra-Creative
Resume

Keep It Simple, Stupid (KISS)

- 1 No headshot
- 2 1 column
- 3 Clear sections with dividers
- 4 Bullet points to split up long text
- 5 Stick to ASCII characters

ALEXANDER CHIOU

1 Hacker Way, Menlo Park, CA

| (555) 555-5555

| awesomeemail@yahoo.com

| GitHub: Gear61

WORK EXPERIENCE

Robinhood

March 2021 – January 2022

Tech Lead

- Led the push to move settings in Robinhood across all platforms (web, iOS, Android) to a server-driven framework, allowing the company to ship new settings faster to meet compliance requirements

Facebook

May 2017 – March 2021

Mobile Client Technical Lead

- Mobile client tech lead for all of IG Core Ads Product (~15 engineers)
- Shipped multiple \$100M+ revenue products in IG Story Ads, including dynamic product ads, expandable carousel ads,
- Mentored 10+ engineers (from junior to senior), many of which went up a rating band every half within Facebook's very competitive performance review environment. Managers would delegate growth of their engineers to me.
- Defined and owned the oncall structure for all of IG Core Ads (~25 engineers across both iOS and Android)
- June 2017 – July 2018: Built the entire Facebook voice assistant for the Facebook Portal from scratch

Course Hero

June 2016 – May 2017

Android Technical Lead

**Stand out by being incredibly
competent, not desperately “creative”.**

Self Ratings

In a Scale of 1-10,
Where Would You Rate
Yourself?



SKILLS

SEO



Public Speaking



Negotiation





Junior Engineer

*"My Java skills are
9/10."*



Hiring Manager

*"So if I grab 100
random Java
engineers, you will be
better than ~90 of
them?"*

Esoteric Terms

I hear what you're saying
but I just don't care.



It's Not Cool, It's Confusing

- Engineers often struggle with empathy
 - Leads to the assumption that others have a similar worldview
- **Problem:** Recruiters are very different from engineers
 - Overly technical terms are confusing
- *Make things simple*



How To Not Be Confusing

- ✓ Explain tech-specific, company-specific, and product-domain specific terms (or just drop them)
- ✓ Avoid acronyms as much as possible
- ✓ Just remove confusing terms
- ✓ Have a non-technical person read your resume

Before

“Used an ExtendScript keyframes framework called Showreel Native to unlock rapid animation iteration across Android and iOS, increasing the CTR of DR ads by 8% and the EBR by 2%”



After

“Built a platform to allow designers to instantly ship new ad formats, increasing IG Story Ads revenue by \$100M/year”



ATS Obsession

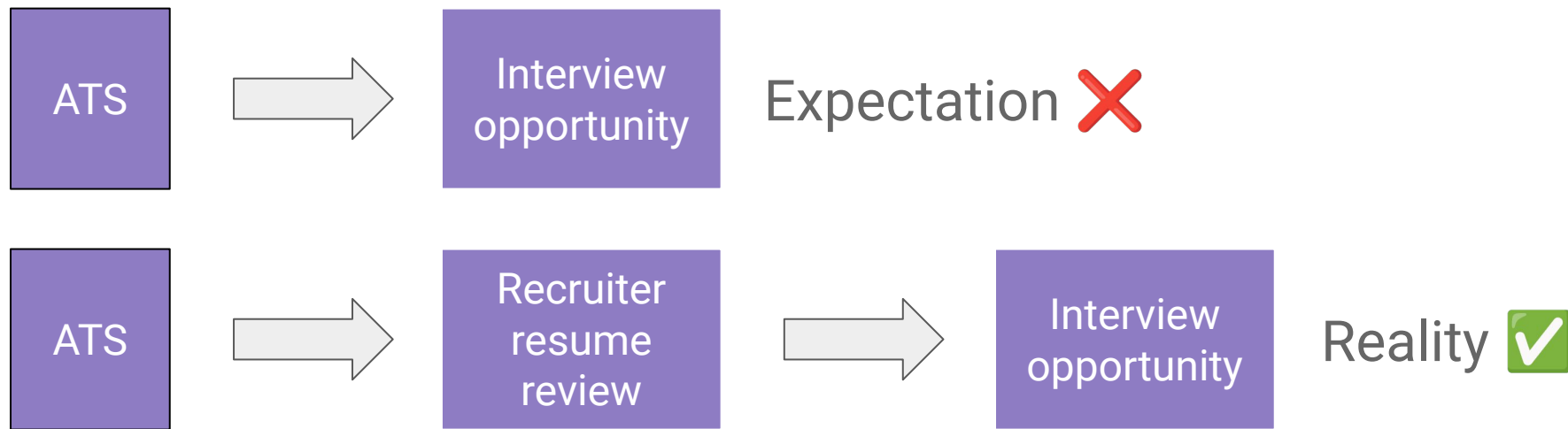


**DON'T LOSE THE FOREST FOR
THE TREES**

So What's An ATS?

- ATS = Applicant Tracking System
- It allows hiring teams to take in and process candidates
- ATS's can screen resumes automatically
 - Operates as a basic sanity check
- Junior devs fixate on them





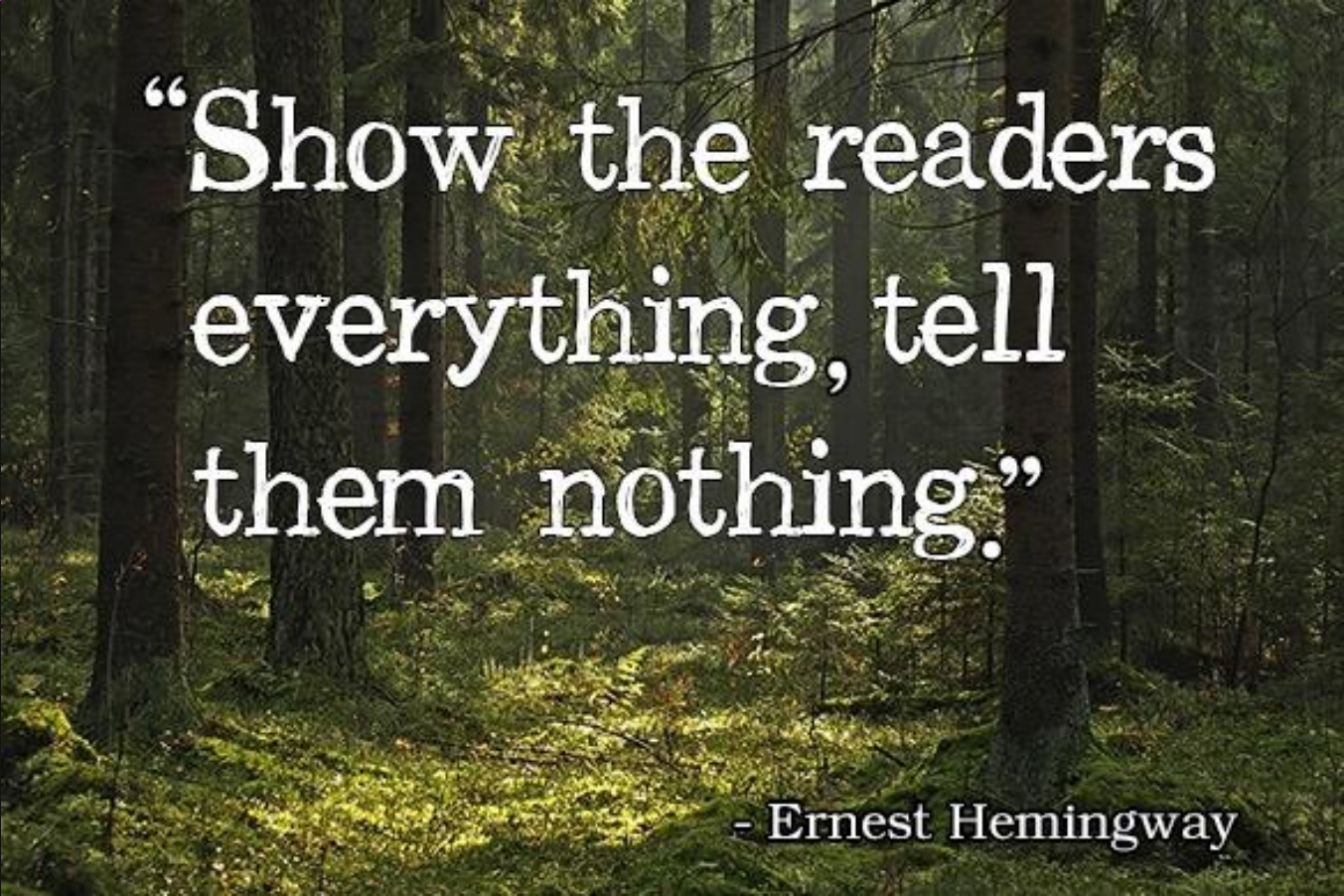
It is *incredibly* dangerous for a company to automate the investment of interview time (which is why they don't do it). 🙄

How To “Beat” The ATS

- 1 Have a simple format (.docx friendly)
- 2 Include relevant keywords (check against JD)
- 3 Follow the advice from this course...

Framing Your Experience

Show, Don't Tell

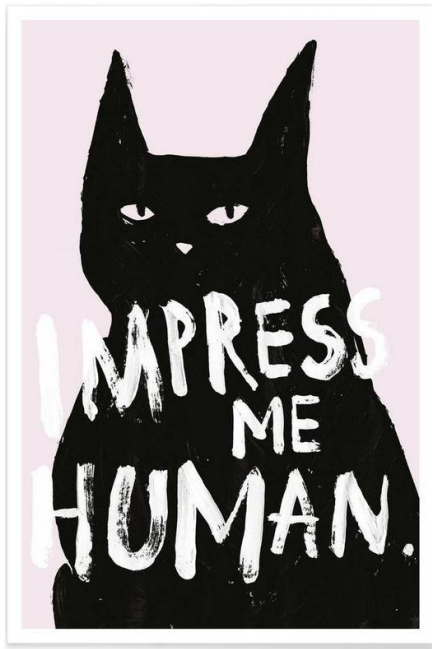
A photograph of a dense forest with tall, thin trees and a thick canopy. Sunlight filters through the leaves, creating a dappled light effect on the forest floor. The text is overlaid on this image.

“Show the readers
everything, tell
them nothing.”

- Ernest Hemingway

Good Accomplishments Speak For Themselves

- Don't just say what you did:
Explain why it matters
- Anybody can do a bunch of random technical stuff
 - All they need to do is follow a tutorial
- Include metrics if possible
 - User count is easiest
- Your mom should be able to understand your resume



Before

Cool Company

Android Engineer

August 2015 – May 2017

- Added Google login to the onboarding flow using Firebase SDK
- Wrote unit tests for the Android app with JUnit and Java
- Migrated the local database infrastructure to Room
- Led the Android team with strong communication and architecture skills

After

Cool Company

Android Engineer

August 2015 – May 2017

- Lead Android engineer for Cool Company's Android app, which has 500k+ installs, 125k+ active users, and a 4.5+ rating
- Added the much user-demanded Google login to the onboarding flow, increasing sign-ups by 30%
- Drove a unit testing effort, getting Android test coverage from 0% -> 80% and reducing customer bug tickets by 50%
- Migrated database code to the Room SDK, reducing schema bugs by 90% and making DB code far easier to write
- Built and owned the entire hiring process end to end for the Android team and grew the team from 1 to 5 engineers
- Technologies used: Firebase, JUnit, Java, Kotlin, Espresso, Retrofit, Room, MVVM

Weak Verbs

- “Participated in”
- “Helped with”
- “Worked on”
- “Contributed to”



Strong Verbs

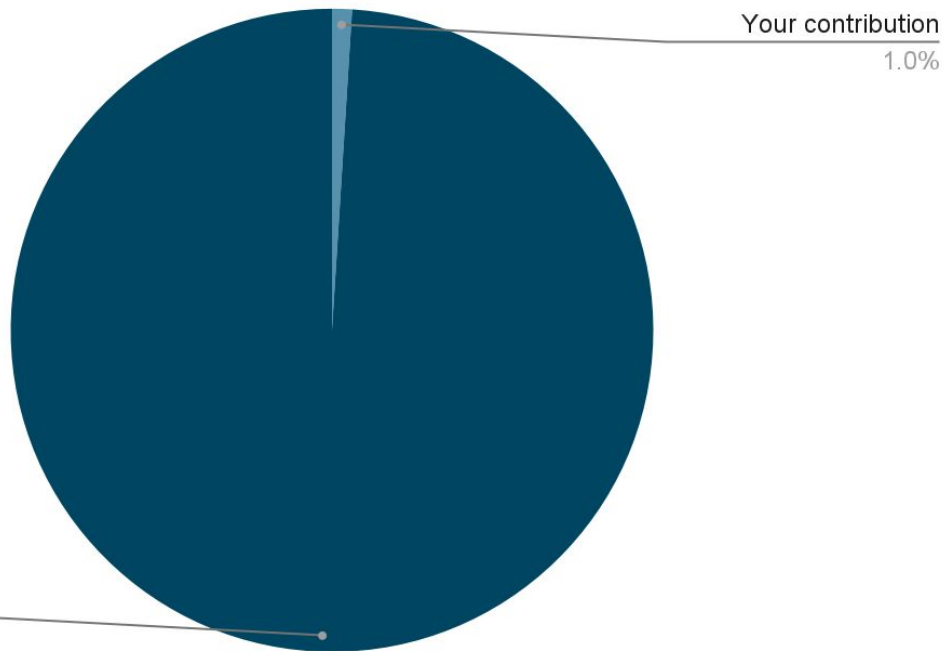
- “Drove”
- “Led”
- “Built”
- “Designed”



Use these
(duh)

“I helped with this project”

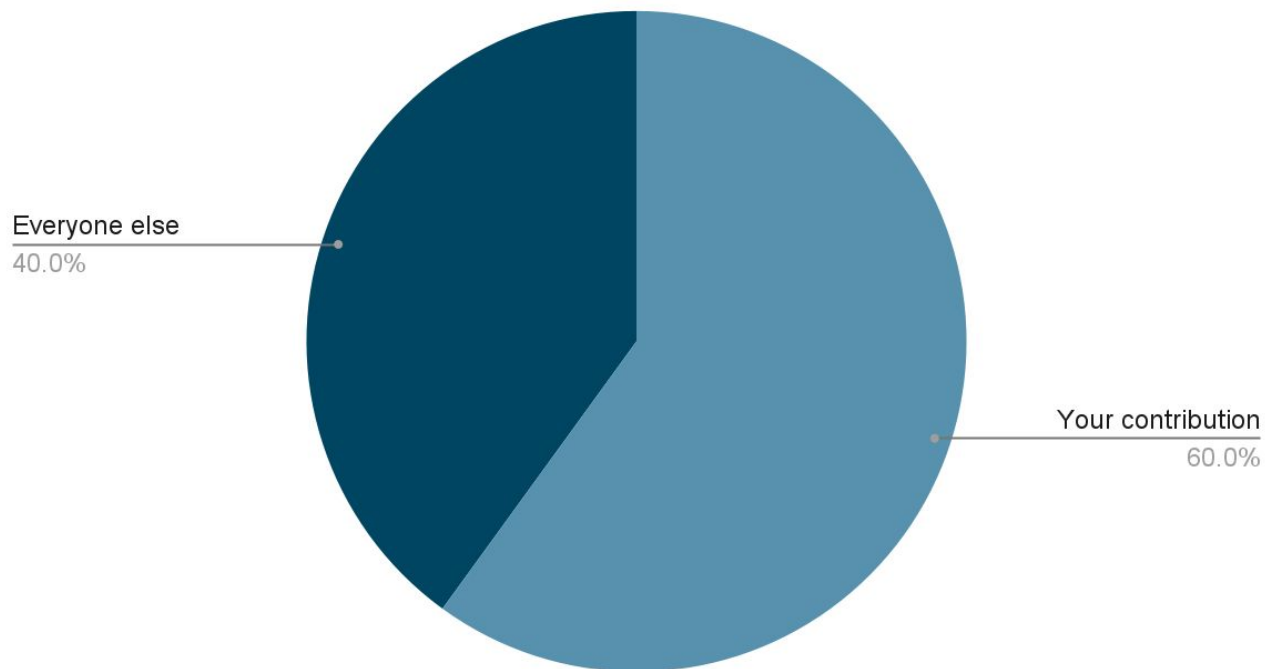
Project Credit



“I led this project”



Project Credit



Ordering



Most Practical -> Least Practical

- **Goal:** Show that you can ship real code to production
- Hierarchy:
 - **Work experience** - Most valuable, highest grade
 - **Personal projects** - Shipping informal code
 - **Education** - Mostly irrelevant, toy “projects”



Default Resume Order

① Work experience (including internships)

② Projects

③ Education

④ Everything else (publications, awards)

Resume Order For 0 Experience Students

① Education (highlight your GPA if it's good)

② Projects



GOOD LUCK!
(you'll need it)

Leveling

✕ Apple	✕ Uber	✕ Google	✕ Facebook	✕ Microsoft
ICT2 Junior Software Engineer	Software Engineer I 3	L3 SWE II	E3	SDE 59
ICT3 Software Engineer	Software Engineer II 4	L4 SWE III	E4	SDE II 61
ICT4 Senior Software Engineer	Senior Software Engineer 5a	L5 Senior SWE	E5	Senior SDE 63
ICT5	Senior Software Engineer II 5b	L6 Staff SWE	E6	Principal SDE 65
ICT6	Staff Software Engineer 6	L7 Senior Staff SWE	E7	66
Distinguished Engineer	Senior Staff Software Engineer 7	L8 Principal Engineer	E8	67
Senior Distinguished Engineer	Principal Engineer	L9 Distinguished Engineer	E9	Partner 68
Engineering Fellow		L10 Google Fellow		69
				70 Distinguished Engineer
				80 Technical Fellow

Cool Company

Software Engineer (June 2015 - July 2016)

- Did some even cooler things

Software Engineer (June 2014 - June 2015)

- Did cool things

July 2014 – July 2016

Cool Company

Software Engineer

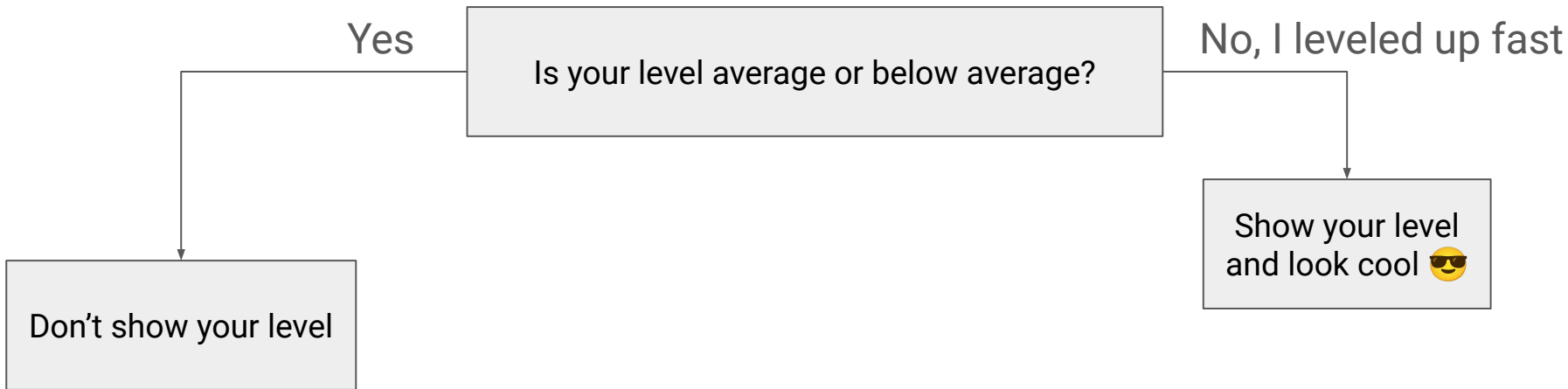
- Did some even cooler things
- Did cool things

July 2014 – July 2016



- Simpler format
- Saves space
- Doesn't expose unnecessary information

Guide To Showing Your Level



Make yourself look as good as possible 🌟

Level Ranges (Approximate)

Junior: 0 to 3 years of experience

Mid-Level: 2 to 8 years of experience

Senior: 5 to 12 years of experience

Staff: 8 - 20 years of experience

Principal: 15+ years of experience

Mid-Level Engineer With **8** Years
Of Experience



Senior Engineer With **3** Years Of
Experience



Projects



Projects Are At A Deficit

- At the end of the day, work experience is still 🏰
 - Projects get far less credit in comparison
- *The main metric to care about is number of users*
 - If a project has ~ 0 users, it can't match professional experience
- Link the live deployment



This Is What A Real Project Section Looks Like

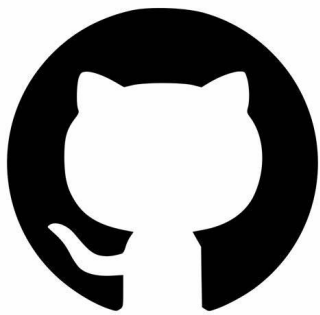
PROJECTS

Random Name Picker (Android Application)

July 2015 – Present

- 1,100,000+ downloads in the Google Play Store with a 4.6 rating after 5,600+ reviews
- Clean simple app with backported Material Design, featuring many customization options such as chosen name announcement, renaming/editing/deleting for both lists and names, and several choosing options like presentation mode
- Used to great success by thousands of teachers, raffle organizers, and many more, evident from their reviews





"What am I supposed to do with this? You realize I can't read code right?"



Recruiter



Beautiful Live
Deployment

"Oooh, this is cool!"

General

To learn more about `./waf`, refer to <http://code.google.com/p/waf/> and <http://waf.googlecode.com/svn/docs/wafbook/single.html>

Ideally, you will need only to add your source files in `wscript`, which is basically a Python program.

How to use skeleton

Due to restrictions on `Inxsrv`, several steps necessary to compile and run (if you're using this skeleton):

1. The following lines should be added to your `~/.profile`

```
export PATH=/usr/local/cs/bin:$PATH export LD_LIBRARY_PATH=/u/cs/grad/yingdi/boost/lib:/usr/local/lib64:
$LD_LIBRARY_PATH
```

2. To configure environment

```
./waf configure
```



Recruiter IRL

Alex's student project repos were so bad 😭

N

Watch 95

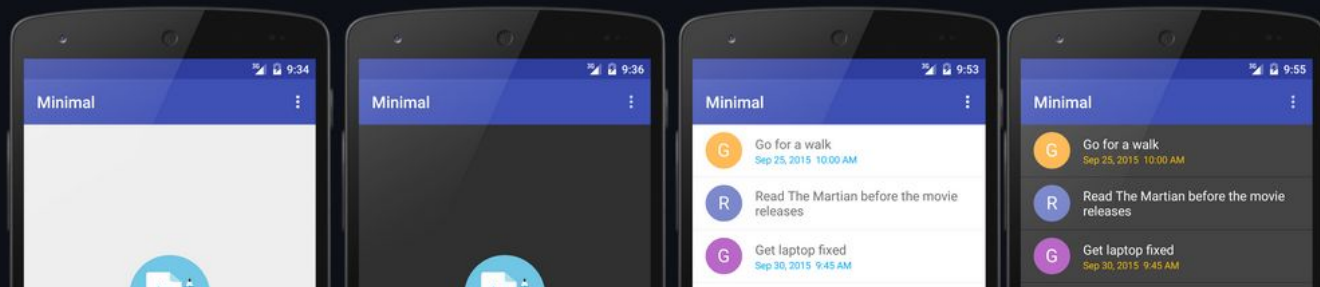
Fork 1k

Star 2.2k



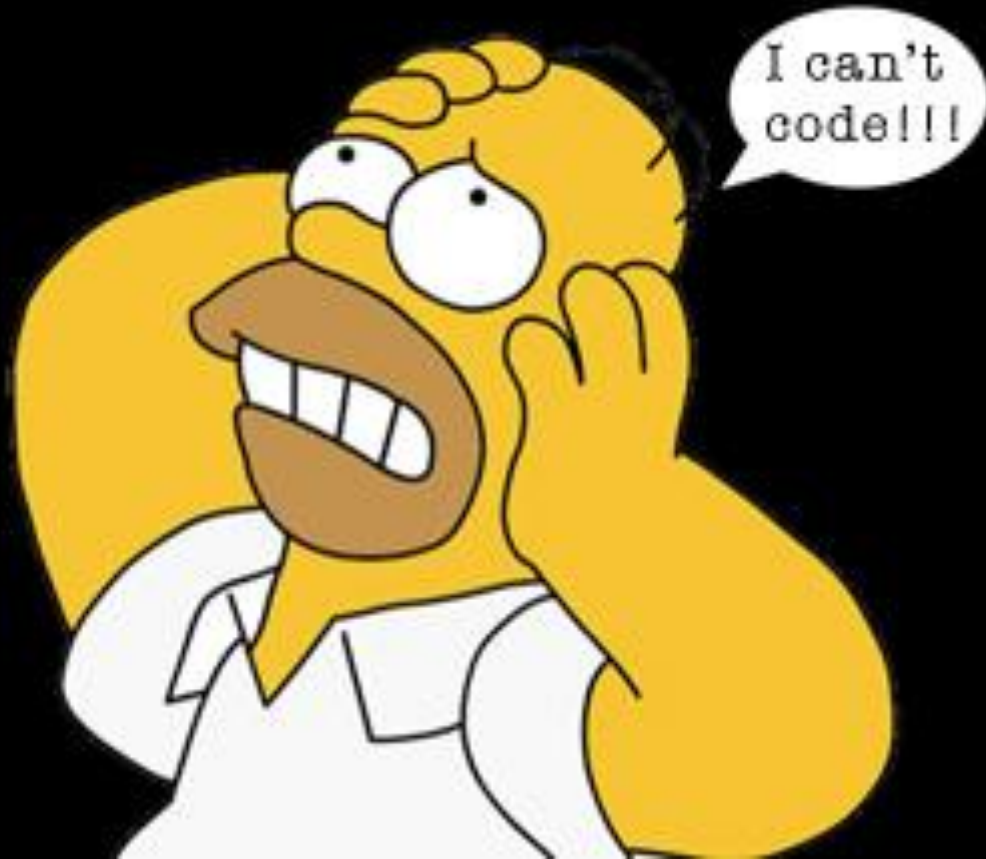
A fully Material ToDo app with minimal features, just enough to be useful.

Screenshots:



Recruiter IRL

Non-Technical Experience



Highlight **Transferable** Skills

Leadership Communication Mentorship
Data analysis Problem solving Project management Proactive thinking
Attention to detail Improving efficiency

**Be proud of your past. It's worth
more than you think 💪**

Hotel Support Manager

- Managed a team of 10 front-line hotel support agents, upholding customer service standards to maintain a 4.5+ star review average across Google Maps, Yelp, and TripAdvisor
- Created a playbook for common customer issues, reducing average help time from 8 minutes to 4 minutes (50% gain)
- Drove the effort to switch vendors for our hotel support management software, saving us \$250,000+ per year

— Leadership

— Proactive, data-driven

— Communication, efficiency-minded

When You Don't Have Enough

I'm a noob.

The Student Struggle

- You cannot go below 1 page
 - It's a red flag
- Don't feel bad about this:
Everyone starts off this way!
- Use this feeling as motivation to get better
- Be creative and thorough looking through your past
- In parallel, create your own experience (covered later)



“I don’t even have 1 page 😭”

① Expand your Education section with courses

② Add more projects (school, personal)

③ Add non-technical experience

④ Increase font size and spacing

*These are short-term fixes

Do Not Lie





*"...increasing the efficiency
of the team by 55%"*



Alex Reading A Resume



One bad apple can spoil
the bunch. 🍎💀

**Hiring liars is deadly. Win with
integrity.**

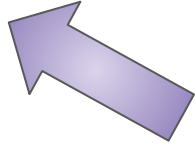
Conclusion

The REAL Secret For A Top Tier Resume



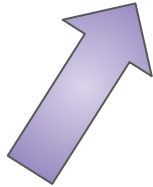
How To Have An Amazing Resume

Step 1: Have amazing experience



This is on you

Step 2: Present your experience well



What this course
helps you with

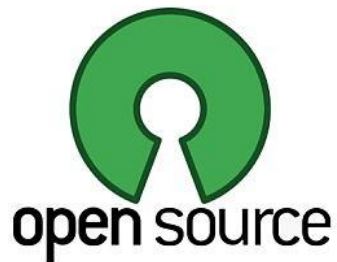


Engineer
Struggling To
Get Interviews

*"But I need
companies to give me
experience - Aren't I
completely helpless?"*



"You are not."



Nobody Can Stop You From Building

- *As a software engineer, you have the power to create value out of thin air*
 - All you need is a computer and an internet connection
- You don't need a professional environment to ship real code to production
- You improve by building



**you're far more
powerful than you
think**

Side Projects: Quick Tips

- 1 *Build something for yourself/loved ones*
- 2 Make the v1 dead simple (i.e. a real MVP)
- 3 Dogfood and consistently iterate
- 4 Win with quality

Alex's Side Projects



Random Name Picker - 1,100,000+ Users



Random Number Generator - 860,000+ Users



SQL Practice Pro - 690,000+ Users



Simple Flashcards Plus - 190,000+ Users

Interview Opportunities From Side Projects



Open Source: Quick Tips

- 1 *Improve a repo you use yourself*
- 2 Pay attention to contribution guidelines
- 3 Learn by doing
- 4 Be a code review feedback sponge

You don't need anybody's permission to build cool stuff.

Go Deeper: Follow Through



Be a Person Who
FOLLOWS THROUGH

Put yourself in the shoes of a recruiter.

Win with competency, not “creativity”.

Build, build, build.

1 page is enough.

Show, don't tell.



Professor Alex's Homework For You

- ❑ Get metrics for as many of your projects as possible
- ❑ Double verify your resume's spelling and grammar
- ❑ Copy Alex's resume if you need a better format
- ❑ Publish a side project and update it 15+ times
- ❑ Trim your resume down to 1 page
- ❑ Review someone else's resume

Collaborative Resume Review Meetup #12



Event details

 Friday, May 24, 2024 1:00pm PDT to
Friday, May 24, 2024 2:00pm PDT

 [Add to Google Calendar](#)

 [Add to Apple Calendar](#)

 [Add to Outlook Calendar](#)

 Taro Premium

This event has ended



16 people attended

Title

How to show the impact of an internal tool on my resume?

Body

Add more details - the more information you share, the better the community can help you!

H **B** *I* S ☰ ☷ “ </> 🔗

Network With The World's Best Software Engineers

Meet other people in the community to gain insights, meet for coffee chats, pair up for mock interviews, share referrals, and more!

What company do they work at? ▾

What level are they? ▾

Resume Review

1

50 community members match your search



E6 @ Meta, Trust & Safety

Palo Alto, California, United States

I'm happy to help with:

Mock Interviews

Friendly Coffee Chat

Resume Review

Referrals

Offer Evaluation & Career Direction

Connect

I'm looking for help with:

Group Office Hours With Alex - Get Personalized Career Advice Privately

OFFICE HOURS

with

ALEX CHIOU



Event details

 Monday, April 29, 2024 9:30am PDT to
Monday, April 29, 2024 10:30am PDT

 [Add to Google Calendar](#)

 [Add to Apple Calendar](#)

 [Add to Outlook Calendar](#)

 Taro Premium

This event has ended



22 people attended

thank you 